

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 10

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

- 16 In spite of rapid strides made by India in women education, gender equality is still a distant dream. Examine the underlying reasons. What more steps are required to achieve the Sustainable Development Goal 5? (250 Words)
- 17 “The role of women appears paramount than the Government interventions to achieve nutrition security in India”. Do you agree? Give valid arguments. (150 Words)
- 18 Illustrate the meaning of gender gap. Examine how far the activities of women's organisations facilitated bridging the gender gap in independent India. (250 Words)

GS – II ... SOCIAL JUSTICE AND GOVERNANCE

- 16 “Internet Shutdowns are becoming more and more a livelihood problem for the masses”. Support the statement with proper justification. Examine the case for construing access to internet as a fundamental right under the existing provisions of the Constitution. (250 Words)
- 17 Examine how far India’s cutting edge research in atomic energy is benefiting the healthcare sector. (150 Words)
- 18 What do you understand by Habitat Approach? How far is the “Housing for All” aligned in this direction? Examine the constraints in achieving the goal of “Housing for All” by 2022 under PMAY-U? (250 Words)

GS – III ... ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

- 16 The Government policy interventions enabled solving the “food crisis” but not the “farm crisis”. Elaborate the statement. What steps are required to solve the “farm crisis” with broader nutrition strategy? (250 Words)
- 17 “India urgently needs an employment and income generation strategy to create jobs and augment the incomes”. Elaborate the statement with specific policy interventions needed. (150 Words)
- 18 Self Help Groups made huge impact in alleviating poverty in rural areas. Critically examine various bottlenecks in forging similar strategy to alleviate farmers’ distress through Farmers’ Producers Organisations. (250 Words)

GS – IV ...ETHICS & INTEGRITY

- 28 Discuss about strengthening ethical and moral values in politics and political executive. (250 Words)
- 29 Discuss measures to strengthen moral values in permanent executive. (150 Words)
- 30 Explain e-Kranti as a step towards e-governance and good governance. (150 Words)

In spite of rapid strides made by India in women education, gender equality is still a distant dream. Examine the underlying reasons. What more steps are required to achieve the Sustainable Development Goal 5? (250 Words)

According to the first SDG Gender Index, no country in the world is on the track to achieve gender equality by 2030. India is ranked 95th among 129 countries. India's performance on gender equality is good in parameters like education, health, hunger and nutrition and energy. But India's lowest scores are on partnership, industry, infrastructure and innovation. It shows the need for greater emphasis for gender equality in these areas.

UNDERLYING REASONS FOR NOT REALISING GENDER EQUALITY

1. CULTURAL REASONS

- Culture of associating women with household chores
- Gender roles during socialization of children by anticipating future domestic role of women

2. PSYCHOLOGICAL REASONS

- Patriarchal mindset of male dominated society
- Attitudes of perceiving women as weaker sex

3. POLITICAL REASONS

- Absence of equal share of power to women at Parliament level
- Proxy representatives of women at local governance level disables the benefits associated with reservation for women in local governance



4. SOCIAL FACTORS

- Encouraging women participation varies across societies with southern states like Tamil Nadu, Kerala faring well
- Absence of choice of conception to women in states like Bihar
- Son meta-preference puts women's health at stake

5. ECONOMIC REASONS

- Companies perceiving maternity as liability
- Concentration of women in Pink collar jobs
- Absence of public and social security to women in informal sector

STEPS REQUIRED TO ACHIEVE SDG 5

- Enabling greater women reservation in assemblies and parliament
- Introducing paternal leave aspect in maternity act
- Campaigns by celebrities and use of social media to enable attitudinal and behavioral changes
- Social security measures for women in informal sector
- Strict enforcement of existing gender laws
- Expanding the success in primary education to secondary and tertiary levels

THE WAY AHEAD

State should collaborate with civil society and self help groups to reach women of disadvantaged sections and make them aware and participate in realizing rights.



“The role of women appears paramount than the Government interventions to achieve nutrition security in India”. Do you agree? Give valid arguments. (150 Words)

Women play multiple roles in achieving nutritional security. The government interventions should empower and become means to realise these roles. According to NFHS-4, more than 50% of women in India are anaemic, which shows poor nutritional status of women.

WOMEN'S ROLES IN ACHIEVING NUTRITION GOALS

1. CARE OF FEMALE CHILDREN

- Child care and feeding responsibilities to be equal for both boy and girl child

2. WOMEN AS PROVIDERS

- Women's employment, income and decision-making power and their nutritional knowledge regarding food influence nutrition status of household.
- Better status enables better nutrition standards

3. WOMEN'S SOCIAL STATUS

- Perception of women as weaker sex puts them last and least in food intake

4. AWARENESS ABOUT EARLY MARRIAGE AND CHOICE OF CONCEPTION

WOMEN'S ROLE IN GOVERNMENT INITIATIVES

- Women at Anganwadi's, ANM implement these initiatives
- Better training to women brings better results
- Incentives to women influence the mode of implementation
- Have ability to attract more children to access nutrition

CONCLUSION

Participation of women is of utmost need for realizing the goals of schemes like Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao and Mid day meal etc. Their affinity with children is unique and decides the success of these government interventions.

Illustrate the meaning of gender gap. Examine how far the activities of women's organisations facilitated bridging the gender gap in independent India. (250 Words)

- Gender gap is the difference between women and men as reflected in social, political, intellectual, cultural or economic attainments or attitudes
Eg: Gender gap in economics is the difference between men and women as seen in salaries paid, the number of leaders and participation in workforce.
- In parameters of women's health and survival and economic participation, India is now ranked in the bottom-five in the survey.
- Though, India slipped to 112th rank in recent global gender gap index, India has bridged two-thirds of its overall gender gap since independence in which women organisations played active role.



WOMEN ORGANISATIONS POST INDEPENDENCE – BRIDGING GENDER GAP

1. Self-employed women's association

- Provide full employment and self-reliance to women
- Social security including basic services to protect and promote well-being.

2. Kudumbashree

- Training to setup micro enterprises like cattle-rearing and poultry farming
- Micro financing to organic farming, tailoring units, catering units etc.

3. National Commission for Women

- Rashtriya Mahila Kosh for funding poor and needy women who form self-help groups

4. Success of women organizations in bridging cultural gender gap

- Hindu marriage act conferring equal rights of divorce on both men and women
- Delegitimizing instant triple talaq

FINALLY

Large scale efforts in bridging gender gap on economic and political fronts are much needed. As envisaged in Article 39 of the Indian Constitution, more women participation at workplace would also pave the way for “equal pay for equal work”. Establishing gender equality ministry on lines of South Korea is recommended.

**16/ SJG
GS - II**

**“Internet Shutdowns are becoming more and more a livelihood problem for the masses”.
Support the statement with proper justification. Examine the case for construing access to
internet as a fundamental right under the existing provisions of the Constitution. (250 Words)**

More than 95% of Indians use the internet on their phones. Thus, a blanket ban on internet remains the natural way for authorities to curb nuisance and spread of misinformation. 67% of world's documented internet shutdowns took place in India. But it is adversely affecting the livelihoods of masses.

INTERNET SHUTDOWN – EFFECT ON LIVELIHOODS

- Food and grocery delivery services such as Zomato, Swiggy etc. become unavailable
- Disruption of wireless card machines affects small scale businesses
- Difficulty in reaching office for those depending on cab aggregators
- Facilities such as Petrol/CNG accept only cash payments
- Significant impact on small and medium enterprises with no means to switch to alternatives
- Online commerce will be crippled in these regions
- Families get disrupted with absence of incomes



CONSTRUING ACCESS TO INTERNET AS FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT

- Internet as fundamental right under right to privacy of Article 21 is upheld by Kerala High Court.
- Human rights internationally construe access to internet as basic human right.
- Internet is necessary for enabling right to information, which is a fundamental right.
- Informed citizens deepen democratic process.

Thus, internet shutdown results in disrupting basic fundamental rights and affecting the functioning of democracy.

THE WAY FORWARD

State has to balance the need of surveillance in public interest and protect the right to access internet by public. Establishing a committee to set a procedure in such situations may be considered.

Examine how far India's cutting edge research in atomic energy is benefiting the healthcare sector. (150 Words)

Board of Radiation and Isotope Technology (BRIT) under Atomic Energy Department is responsible for production and supply of medical products linked to human health.

NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY IN HEALTH SERVICES

Produce radio isotopes for diagnostic and therapeutic use of cancer care

Eg:

- Cyclotron Cyclone-30 produces Germanium 68 radioisotopes, used in diagnosis of breast cancer
- Palladium 103 isotopes for treating prostate cancer

Radio genomics to study genetic variation associated with response to radiation

NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY

PET based products for cardiac and neuro diseases

Molecular imaging to deliver precise diagnosis based on specific molecular disease process (eg: Genetic Mutation)

Relieving cancer borne pain and in cancer therapy

Radio treatment of municipal waste in cities and conversion to organic manure

Technology for purification of water



CONCLUSION

- Though Department of Atomic Energy is mostly concerned with energy generation, it must continue to develop applications for multiple challenges, including pollution, climate change etc.
- Faster adoption of these technologies by different public and private agencies and speeding up diffusion of these applications must become a priority area.

What do you understand by Habitat Approach? How far is the “Housing for All” aligned in this direction? Examine the constraints in achieving the goal of “Housing for All” by 2022 under PMAY-U? (250 Words)

- Habitat approach under UN Habitat is a vision of sustainable human settlements where all have adequate shelter, a healthy and safe environment, basic services and productive life in harmony with nature.
- PMAY (Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana) is a housing scheme with objective of housing for all by 2022. It includes PMAY (Urban) and PMAY (Gramin). PMAY (Urban) is of more relevance to habitat approach.

PMAY (HOUSING FOR ALL - URBAN)



CONSTRAINTS IN ACHIEVING GOAL UNDER PMAY-U

- Capital constraints and fear of defaults resulted in banks shying away from lending to affordable housing under Credit Linked Subsidy Scheme (CLSS)
- No availability of enough urban land
- Administration and regulatory bottle necks
- Environmental concerns
- Lack of people's participation in absence of awareness
- Delay in approvals from urban local bodies (ULBs)
- Requirement of attitudinal and behavioral change towards decent living among slum dwellers
- Identifying beneficiaries especially among slums where data is scarcely available

THE WAY AHEAD

The success strategy of people's participation and people's movement has to be evolved in PMAY. Ensuring removal of bottlenecks, single window, time bound clearance for approval and building permissions at ULBs level are needed.

The Government policy interventions enabled solving the “food crisis” but not the “farm crisis”. Elaborate the statement. What steps are required to solve the “farm crisis” with broader nutrition strategy? (250 Words)

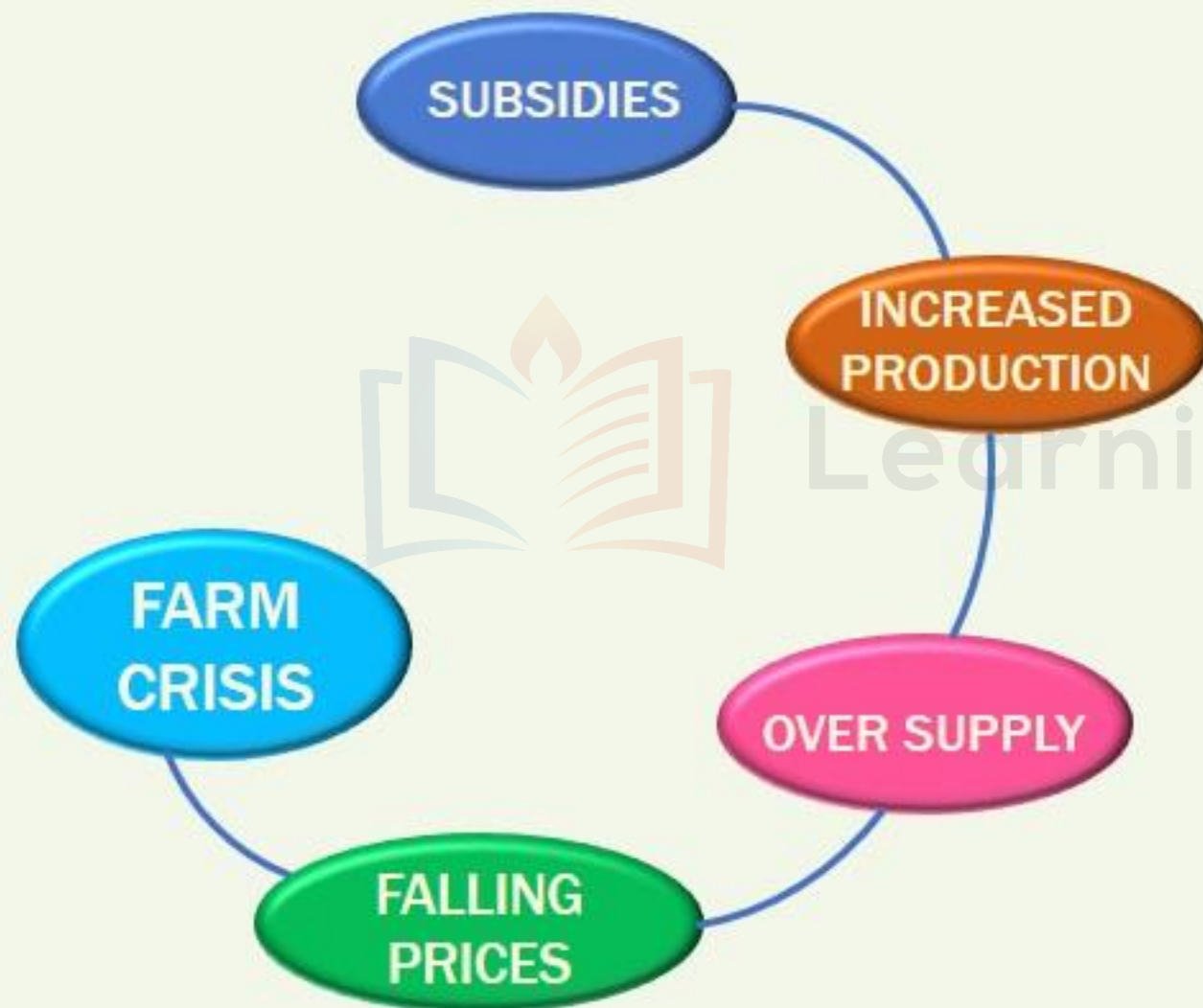
Indian agriculture has seen a dramatic change since the 1960s because of technological innovations. Despite progress in food self-sufficiency, there is farm crisis including distress prices and farmer suicides etc.

GOVERNMENT POLICY INTERVENTIONS IN SOLVING THE FOOD CRISIS:

1. Green Revolution
2. Targeted Public Distribution System
3. Promoting food crops through MSPs
4. Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchai Yojana (PMKSY) resulted in better irrigation
5. Technology missions for increasing crop productivity

Eg: National Mission on Oilseeds and Palm Oil
National Pulses Development Project
Accelerated Maize Development Program

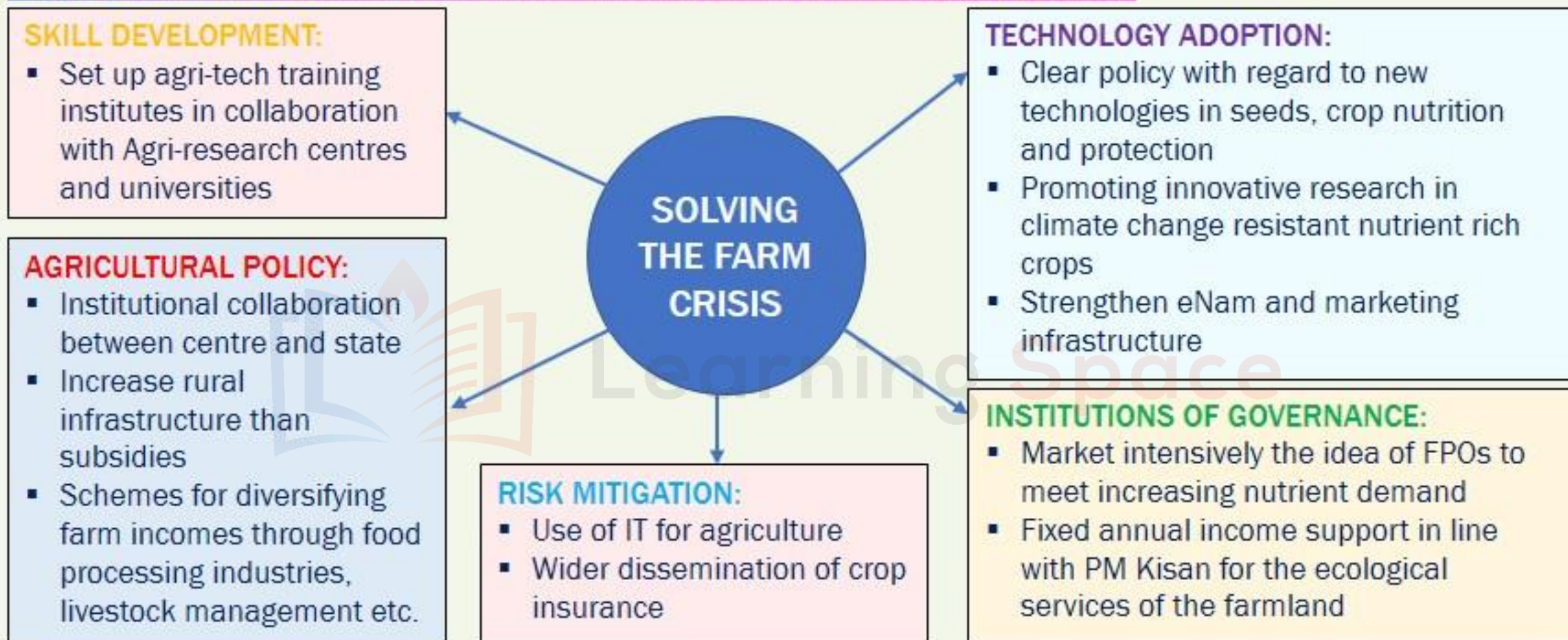




ISSUES OF FARM CRISIS

1. Cost implications of regulations
2. Hidden taxes on inputs
3. Cost of and access to capital
4. Market access and tariff rates
5. Changing dietary patterns and over supply of food crops
6. Less than 10% of the country's farmers benefit from MSPs (NSSO 2012-13)
7. MSPs benefit large farmers and exclude many of country's marginal farmers
8. Loan-waiver is likely to benefit only 30% as only about 30% of Indian agricultural households took loans from the institutions.

SOLVING THE FARM CRISIS WITH BROADER NUTRITION STRATEGY



CONCLUSION

Cash transfers and loan waivers may not be the solution to the farm crisis. Larger investments in improving access to better technology, extension programmes by integrating them to National nutrition mission and enabling private sector participation are necessary.

“India urgently needs an employment and income generation strategy to create jobs and augment the incomes”. Elaborate the statement with specific policy interventions needed. (150 Words)

India's Unemployment rate hit 45 year high in 2018. As per NSSO, more than 90% of India's labour force are in unorganised sector. This rate of unemployment and dependence on unorganised sector created an environment where the avenues to augment the incomes are inadequate.

NEED FOR THE EMPLOYMENT AND INCOME GENERATION

- More than a million-workforce entering job market annually
- To shift workforce from stagnating agriculture
- Empower individuals to attain self-sufficiency in basic needs
- Enhance GDP to achieve the goal of \$5 trillion economy by 2024
- Constitutional duty of the state to provide Social and Economic Rights under Part-IV

POLICY INTERVENTIONS NEEDED

- Fiscal reforms to boost private investments and embrace new technologies like 5G etc.
- Outsourcing back office jobs to rural areas
- Unorganized sector to be converted gradually to organized sector
- Major drive for filling the government jobs which are vacant over the years
- Focus on vocational training on the lines of China
- Institutional reforms to promote MSMEs
- One District One Product scheme of Uttar Pradesh can be emulated across the country

CONCLUSION

Thus, employment generation and income augmentation not only promote social and economic justice, it will also enhance internal security, citizen-state relations and channelize the demographic bulge to a demographic dividend.

Self Help Groups made huge impact in alleviating poverty in rural areas. Critically examine various bottlenecks in forging similar strategy to alleviate farmers' distress through Farmers' Producers Organisations. (250 Words)

Self Help Group is seen by many as a catalyst for rural development, and women and social empowerment. On the other hand, as per the NSSO data, 51.4% of the farmer households do not have access to formal credit. This has led to many negative implications such as poverty, farmer suicides. FPOs that can forge the strategy of SHGs can help solve this problem, if the bottlenecks are removed.



BOTTLENECKS IN FORGING SHGs STRATEGY TO ALLEVIATE FARMERS' DISTRESS THROUGH FPOs

- Fragmented land holdings result in low productivity and hinder infusion of technology and new farming techniques.
- Farmers' inefficiency
 - ✓ to act as managers or CEOs of the FPOs,
 - ✓ in understanding of various resource optimization techniques
 - ✓ to update with best agri-practices and
 - ✓ in representation of farmers as a group in organized market
- Absence of private sector participation negated the avenues for institutional credit and other inputs.
- Farming practice being driven by government policies like MSPs.
- Lack of enough cold chain and storage infrastructure and processing capacity.
- Existence of caste barriers discouraged co-operative farming.

SOME OF THE POLICY REFORMS

- Allowing private equity, angel investor and venture capital support to FPOs.
- Amendments in Food Grain Procurement policy is required to allow procurement of produce directly from FPOs under MSP scheme.
- Specified funds can be created or diverted from Government to build infrastructure at FPO level.
- Liberal statutory compliances may be provided for FPOs initially.
- Amendments in the APMC Act to enable FPOs market their produce directly to the consumers/ bulk-buyers, without payment of Mandi Fee.
- Convergence of delivering various farmer and agriculture related schemes through FPOs.
- A single window can be introduced for issuance of all licenses to FPOs, to ease the process of doing business.
- Awareness and capacity building of farmers and position holders in FPOs should be done on regular interval to help them understand the real benefit of institution.

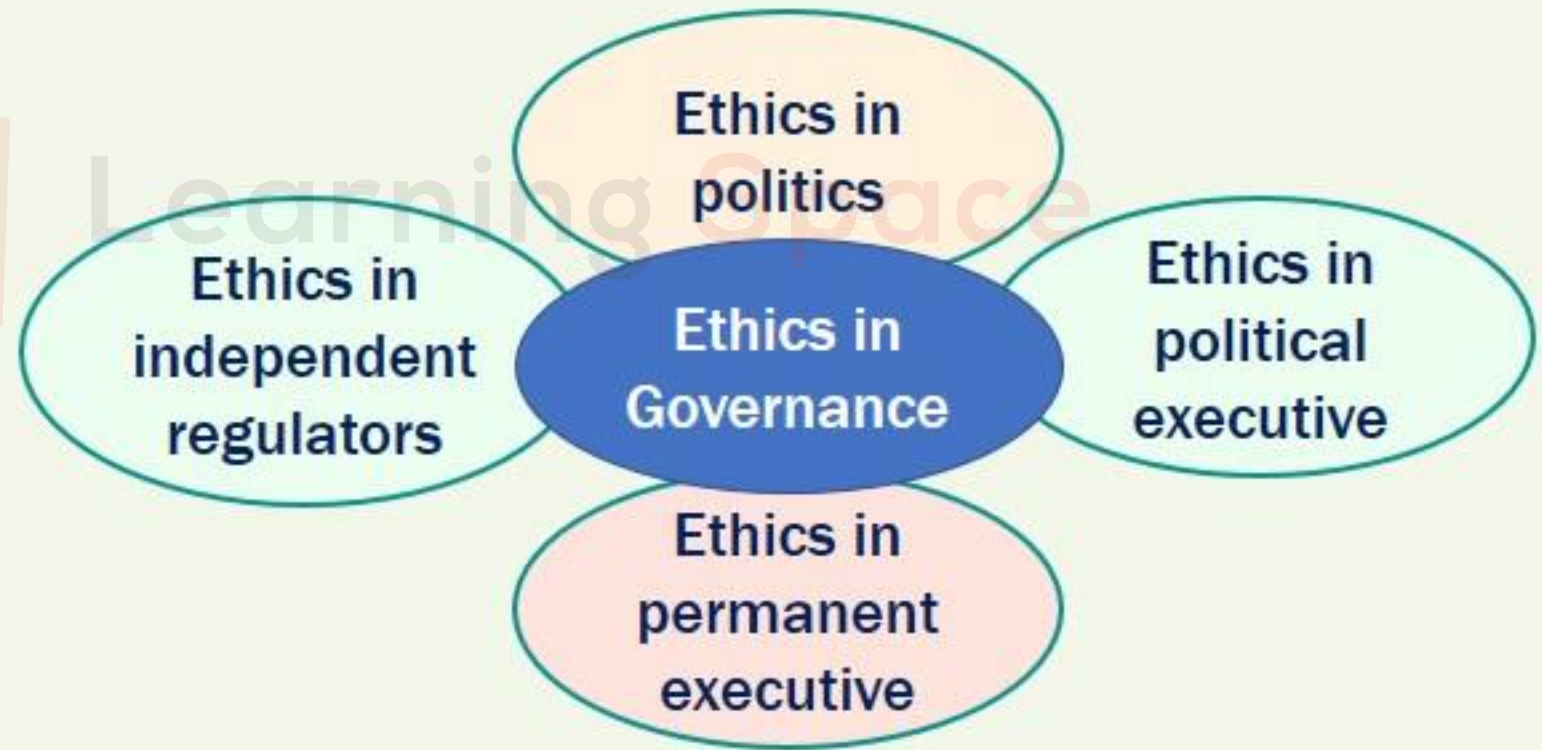
THE WAY AHEAD

An inclusive and affable ecosystem is required for any producer organizations to develop and nurture to deal with issues starting from farm till far-away markets. State support through various regulatory bodies like NABARD should be strengthened.



Discuss about strengthening ethical and moral values in politics and political executive. (250 Words)

It is a common perception that ethical and moral values have hit rock bottom. Hence, it is of prime importance to strengthen the same for public good. Governance comprises of various components that include politics and political executive.



STRENGTHENING ETHICS IN POLITICS

- Enforcing proper accounting on political parties. Their donations and expenditure must be audited by an independent agency akin to election commission
- Digital means for political funding
- Internal democracy in political parties to prevent dynastic politics and entry of unscrupulous individuals into corridor of power
- Periodic public disclosure of education qualifications, criminal history, assets and liabilities of all members of political party
- Except for some confidential information and election-sensitive information, political parties should be brought under RTI
- Promoting ethics among members of political parties by
 - ✓ Role plays
 - ✓ Immersion programs
 - ✓ Discourses on ethics and display of tenants of ethics in party offices etc.

STRENGTHENING ETHICS IN POLITICAL EXECUTIVE



THE WAY AHEAD

Political parties and political executive perform the role of representatives of people. Practice of ethics by them will further get reflected in ethical practices by common man.

Discuss measures to strengthen moral values in permanent executive. (150 Words)

Permanent executive or bureaucracy forms the steel frame of governance structure. Being the cutting edge implementors of government schemes, moral values enable delivery of good governance.

STRENGTHENING MORAL VALUES IN PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

1. Merit based selection

- Procedure for selection should be based on an impartial exam, with utmost transparency about the conduct of the same.

2. Ethics as part of training

- Every government servant should undergo courses on ethics in governance.

3. Integrity Pact

- Signing integrity pact by government servants while awarding contracts to any outside parties.

4. Minimal public interface with government servants

- Process of governance to be automated.

5. Public disclosure of assets and liabilities of bureaucrats

6. Call centers to receive complaints against government servants

7. Simplification of rules

- Rules to be designed such that the citizen is not placed at the mercy of government servant. They are to be simple enough for citizens to understand and comply.

CONCLUSION

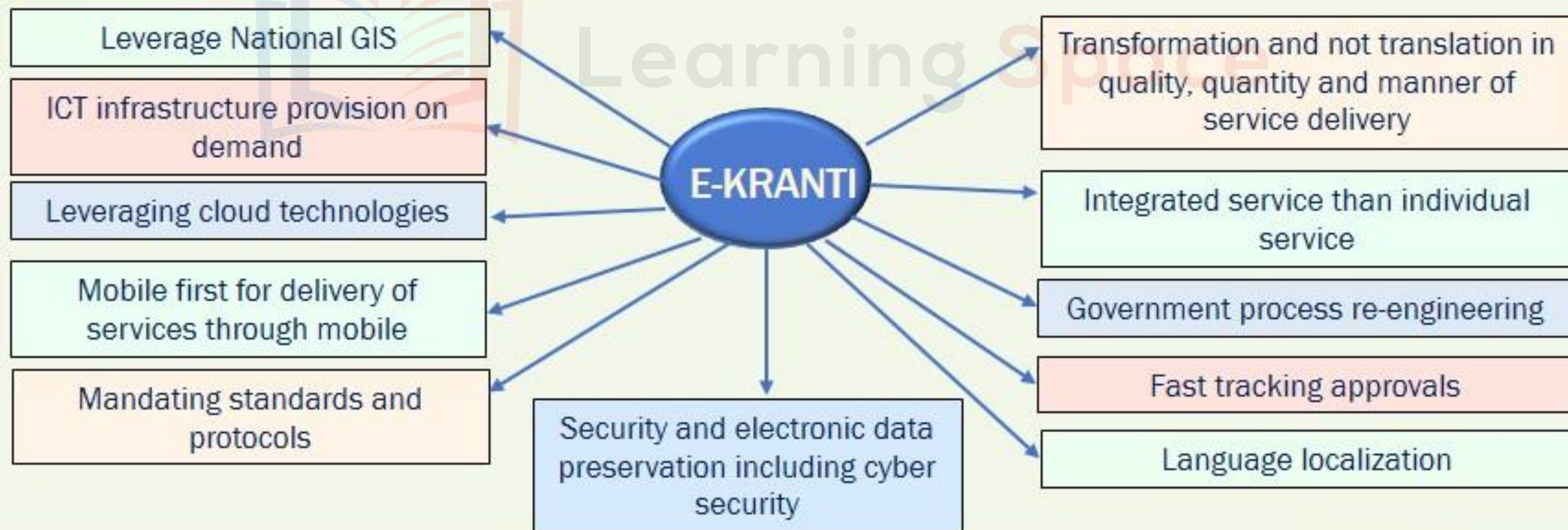
Bureaucrats are provided with responsibility of enabling socio-economic transformation. Their performance and incentives must be linked to abiding by these moral values in delivering governance.



Explain e-Kranti as a step towards e-governance and good governance. (150 Words)

Mission of e-Kranti is to ensure a government wide transformation by delivering all Government services electronically to citizens while ensuring efficiency, transparency and reliability of such services at affordable costs.

KEY PRINCIPLES OF E-KRANTI



THRUST AREAS OF E-KRANTI IN DIGITAL INDIA

TECHNOLOGY FOR:

- Education – E-education and Broadband to all schools
- Health (e-Health)
- Farmers – Real time price information etc.
- Security – Mobile based emergency and disaster services
- Financial Inclusion
- Justice – Interoperable criminal justice system
- Planning
- Cyber security – Safe and secure cyberspace within the country

CONCLUSION

E-Governance in India has steadily evolved from computerization of departments to initiatives that encapsulate citizen centricity, service orientation and transparency. Proper implementation of e-Kranti results in sustaining the same.

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SINCERE THANKS
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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

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0866 244 44 72

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